

FLN Changemaker Presentation

Created with Oboe at oboe.com

Project Proposal: Eradicating Learning Poverty through Foundational Literacy and Numeracy (YouthRise Changemakers)

1. The Problem: The Crisis of Learning Poverty

Globally, learning poverty remains a devastating barrier to human development. Millions of children in informal settlements and rural areas are entering and exiting primary school without mastering basic reading, writing, and numeracy. In low-income countries, 9 in 10 children cannot read or understand a simple text by age ten, even though many are sitting in classrooms.

This is not a child's failure — it is a systemic failure rooted in undertrained teachers, language barriers, overcrowded classrooms, absent early childhood education, hungry learners, and digitally or numerically excluded adults. When children fail to master foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) by Grade 3, the deficit ripples outward into every corner of society:

- **Early School Dropout:** Unskilled learners fall behind, disengage, and drop out prematurely.
- **Vulnerability to Social Crises:** Dropouts face dramatically higher risks of teenage pregnancy, child and early marriage, drug and substance abuse, and long-term hopelessness.
- **Intergenerational Poverty:** Uneducated youth transition into low-skilled adults, locking their own children into the exact same cycle of economic deprivation.

[Unaddressed FLN Gap] → [Grade 3 Dropout] → [Societal Vulnerabilities: Pregnancy, Crime, Poverty]

2. The Solution: YouthRise Changemakers 3-Pillar Community-First Model

To solve learning poverty, we cannot build the house from the roof. We must start on the ground floor by securing foundational literacy and numeracy.

YouthRise Changemakers is an integrated, community-first intervention designed to tackle learning poverty at its root through three interlocking pillars:

☒ Pillar 1 — Teacher Professional Development (PD)

- **Rationale:** Teachers are the single most important school-level factor in learning outcomes. Without equipping them with the right tools, no curriculum reform succeeds.
- **What We Do:** We conduct structured, ongoing professional development co-designed with and endorsed by frameworks like TaRL Africa (Teaching at the Right Level), Uwezo Kenya, and the PAL Network.
- **Training & Strategy:** Focuses on FLN pedagogy, bilingual/mother-tongue delivery models (Swahili and English in informal settlements; Mother tongue transitioning to national languages in rural expansions), activity-based learning, assessment for learning, and inclusive education.

☒ Pillar 2 — Child-Centred Learning Sessions

- **What We Do:** Every child is grouped by ability rather than strict age-grade constraints, fed nutritious porridge to combat hunger-driven cognitive barriers, and taught using engaging, level-appropriate methods (storytelling, games, songs) that foster self-belief and direct academic mastery.

☒☒ Pillar 3 — Adult Literacy & Digital Inclusion Classes

- **What We Do:** Recognizing that children live in homes and communities, we provide adult literacy and digital inclusion classes. This ensures that parents can support learning at home and that the cycle of low literacy does not repeat in the next generation.
-

3. The Impact and Monitoring Framework

YouthRise Changemakers generates compounding, long-term impact across multiple indicators, supported by a rigorous monitoring, evaluation, and learning (MEL) framework:

Indicator		
Category	Key Metric / Target	Monitoring Method & Frequency
Student FLN Mastery	% of Grade 3 learners reading with comprehension and solving basic numeracy problems	Baseline, mid-line, and end-line assessments using TaRL/Uwezo assessment tools (Termly)
Teacher Capacity	% of participating teachers receiving YouthRise FLN Educator certification and demonstrating level-based pedagogy	Classroom observations, coaching logs, and peer learning circle attendance (Monthly/Quarterly)
Educational Attainment	Reduction in primary dropout rates; smooth transition to secondary schooling	School attendance records and community tracking metrics (Annual)
Adolescent & Social Resilience	Delayed adolescent pregnancies and reduced vulnerability to early marriage	Community-level tracking and partner health data integration (Annual)
Community Engagement	Attendance and literacy skill progression in Adult Literacy & Digital Inclusion classes	Class attendance registers and digital literacy competency tests (Bi-annually)

4. Why It Matters: Connecting the Root to the Vision

Addressing foundational literacy and numeracy is not a small ambition — it is the only way to achieve sustainable impact at scale.

My ultimate vision is to serve as co-founder and CEO of an organization that systematically eliminates learning poverty. YouthRise Changemakers is the proving ground for this vision. Every element of executive leadership maps directly onto this work:

- **Shaping Vision:** Translating the abstract global crisis of learning poverty into a hyper-localized, executable theory of change (the three pillars and community-first model).
 - **Building Strong Teams:** Recruiting, training, and retaining community teachers, master trainers, and local mobilizers.
 - **Driving Innovation:** Utilizing context-specific, evidence-based pedagogies that bypass bureaucratic friction to deliver immediate learning gains.
 - **Breaking Cycles of Inequality:** Ensuring that interventions permanently alter community trajectories so that every child and adult has the opportunity to succeed.
-

5. Why Investors Should Back My Vision and Leadership

Investing in this project is an investment in rigorous execution, clear-eyed strategy, and sustainable social architecture. Backing my leadership as co-founder and CEO brings distinct strategic value:

- **Root-Cause Focus:** I understand that scale without a strong foundation is fragile. I am committed to fixing problems at their deepest level rather than applying superficial band-aids.
- **Action-Oriented Leadership:** YouthRise Changemakers is already operationalized as a living model, proving that community-first educational reform is both practical, adaptable, and scalable across urban settlements and rural expansions.
- **Mission-Driven Execution:** As a founder, my objective is not merely running an organization, but creating enduring meaning by empowering communities, building elite teams, and driving generational change.

The CEO I aim to become is being built right here — one learner, one community, and one root cause at a time. Partner with me to turn this vision into a reality.

